THE MARITIME SAFETY COMMITTEE, RECALLING Article 28(b) of the Convention on the International Maritime Organization concerning the functions of the Committee, RECALLING ALSO resolution A.886(21), by which the Assembly resolved that the functions of adopting performance standards and technical specifications for radio and navigational equipment, as well as amendments thereto, shall be performed by the Maritime Safety Committee on behalf of the Organization, RECALLING FURTHER resolution MSC.74(69), Annex 3 - Recommendation on Performance Standards for an Universal Shipborne Automatic Identification System (AIS), REALIZING the application of AIS devices to safety of navigation as well as security, NOTING that the International Tel ecommunications Union Sector for Radiocommunications (ITU-R) recognizes a Cla ss Acategory of AIS meeting the requirements - REALIZING the application of AIS devices to safety of navigation as well as security, NOTING that the International Tel ecommunications Union Sector for Radiocommunications (ITU-R) recognizes a Cla ss Acategory of AIS meeting the requirements of resolution MSC.74(69), as well as Class Band other categories of AIS not meeting the requirements of resolution MSC.74(69), Annex 3, NOTING ALSO that Class Adevices are in tended to meet compulsory AIS fitting requirements of the 1974 SOLAS Convention, and Class Bdevices are intended to meet the needs of vessels, which fit AIS on avoluntary basis, NOTING FURTHER the benefit of Class Bdevices, RECOGNIZING that the radio channels used by AIS, particular ly AIS 1 (161.975 MHz) and AIS 2 (162.025 MHz), are regarded as an AIS network, and any disruption to those channels by any one AIS device could affect the operation of all AIS devices on that network, RECOGNIZING FURTHER the compelling need to ensure the integrity of the AIS VHF data link, RECOMMENDS that: .1 Class B AIS devices, as well as any devi ce which transmits on the radio channels - RECOGNIZING FURTHER the compelling need to ensure the integrity of the AIS VHF data link, RECOMMENDS that: .1 Class B AIS devices, as well as any devi ce which transmits on the radio channels AIS 1 or AIS 2, should meet the appr opriate requirements of Recommendation ITU-R M.1371 (series); .2 Class B AIS devices should be approved by the Administration; .3 Administrations should take steps necessary to ensure the integrity of the radio channels used for AIS in their waters. *** RESOLUTION MSC.140(76) (adopted on 5 December 2002) RECOMMENDATION FOR THE PROTECTION OF THE AIS VHF DATA LINKRESOLUTION MSC.140(76) (adopted on 5 December 2002) RECOMMENDATION FOR THE PROTECTION OF THE AIS VHF DATA LINK - RESOLUTION MSC.141(76) (adopted on 5 December 2002) REVISED MODEL TEST METHOD UNDER RESOLUTION 14 OF THE 1995 SOLAS CONFERENCEMSC 76/23/Add.1 I:\MSC\76\23-ADD.1.DOC ANNEX 17